Show Me the Deal

S&P 500 −0.36% as Monday's rally fades. Brent climbs back above $104. Iran denies talks. COIN −10% on stablecoin legislation.

THE SESSION

Monday's hope trade met Tuesday's reality. The S&P 500 fell 0.36% to 6,557, paring a decline that had approached 1% intraday before President Trump told reporters the U.S. and Iran are "in negotiations right now." The Dow edged down 0.18% to 46,124 and the Nasdaq slid 0.84% to 21,762. The Russell 2000, by contrast, added 0.45%—a small-cap resilience that echoed Monday's risk-on bid but diverged sharply from the large-cap tech weakness that defined Tuesday's tape.

The session's character was set before the open. Iran's parliament speaker dismissed Trump's claims of productive talks as an attempt to manipulate oil markets, calling them "fake news." Brent crude climbed back above $104, erasing much of Monday's 11% decline and confirming the skepticism our pre-market analysis flagged. An explosion at Valero's Port Arthur refinery in Texas—still burning Tuesday morning—added upward pressure to gasoline and diesel futures, though VLO itself rose 1.84% as refining margins widened for competitors. The VIX ticked up 3.06% to 26.95.

Beneath the index-level softness, the tape was bifurcated. Semiconductors and industrials extended Monday's momentum: KEYS +3.33%, ADI +3.09%, TEL +2.78%, CAT +2.13%. Crypto-linked names reversed sharply as proposed stablecoin legislation surfaced and Argus lowered COIN estimates: COIN fell 9.76%, MARA 7.41%, HOOD 4.70%. The digital asset sleeve that led Monday gave back those gains and then some. Gold rebounded 1.23% to $4,461, a notable reversal after its extended losing streak—the kind of session that tends to mark at least a near-term floor.

IOWN Tactical: The S&P 500 remains below its 200-day moving average and roughly 7% off January's 7,002 peak. The five-day diplomatic window through Saturday offers binary risk: concrete progress extends the relief trade, failure to produce a framework returns us to the war premium. We remain positioned through the range of outcomes.

IOWN HOLDINGS: NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

KEYS +3.33% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Led the portfolio for a second straight session. Keysight's semiconductor test equipment demand continues to benefit from the domestic chip manufacturing push, including Tesla's Terafab announcement.

ADI +3.09% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Analog Devices extended its bounce as data-center analog demand remains robust. Analysts noted favorable positioning against competitors in the power management segment.

TEL +2.78% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

TE Connectivity rallied on industrial connector demand. The company's exposure to automotive electrification and data-center infrastructure provided support.

ORI +2.46% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Old Republic continued its steady advance. The specialty insurer benefits from rising premiums in a hardening commercial property market.

CAT +2.13% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Caterpillar climbed as infrastructure spending remains resilient despite macro uncertainty. The company's Middle East exposure is modest relative to its global backlog.

DECLINERS

COIN –9.76% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

The session's largest decliner across the portfolio. Proposed legislation targeting stablecoins weighed on shares, compounded by an Argus earnings estimate cut. COIN is now down roughly 25% year-to-date.

MARA –7.41% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Marathon Digital fell alongside the broader crypto complex. Bitcoin dipped to $70,140 as Tuesday's risk-off tone reversed Monday's digital asset rally.

SSNC –5.01% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

SS&C Technologies declined on continued selling pressure. The stock has been under weight since a short-seller report earlier this month, despite the company's rebuttal.

HOOD –4.70% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Robinhood fell in sympathy with the broader crypto and fintech sell-off. Cathie Wood's ARK has sold shares in recent sessions, adding to negative sentiment.

FTNT –4.14% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Fortinet declined as cybersecurity names gave back recent gains. The pull-back follows an extended run in the sector driven by elevated geopolitical threat levels.

HOLDINGS NEWS

VLO — Port Arthur Refinery Explosion. An explosion at Valero's Port Arthur, Texas facility Monday evening was still

burning Tuesday morning. The diesel-producing unit is expected to be offline for an extended period, while the gasoline unit may restart within weeks. Wholesale gasoline futures rose roughly 10 cents per gallon and diesel 16 cents on the incident. VLO shares rose 1.84% to $241.75 as the disruption widened crack spreads for the broader refining complex.

COIN — Stablecoin Legislation Threat. Reports surfaced of proposed legislation that could restrict stablecoin operations, a key revenue driver for Coinbase. Stablecoin revenue reached $1.34 billion in 2025, up from $910 million the prior year. Argus simultaneously reiterated a Hold rating and lowered earnings estimates, citing ongoing crypto market volatility.

ARM Chip Launch — Read-Through for QCOM. Arm Holdings announced plans to sell its own chips, a move that could make some of its current licensees into competitors. QCOM rose a modest 0.25% on the session as markets assess implications for Qualcomm's licensing arrangements.

PORTFOLIO PERFORMANCE

DIVIDEND STRATEGY ✗ TRAIL

+0.66%

vs. DVY +0.91% | IWS +0.75%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO ✓ BEAT

–0.79%

vs. IUSG –0.83%

YEAR-TO-DATE

Dividend +4.91% vs DVY +5.55% / IWS +3.32%
Growth –2.96% vs IUSG –6.50%